

Positioning Yourself for a Promotion

Take Responsibility

- Be Proactive - whether you are looking for a new role within your current company, or moving to a new firm, you are responsible for managing your career. It is important to be focused on what you want to do, including what skills and experiences you want to develop and utilize as you move forward in your career. This includes staying aware of what skills you need to develop in order to move up and actively working to demonstrate your competency in those areas. It also includes being aware of what the organization needs in order to be successful. If you see an opportunity to streamline a process, improve a relationship with a client, or provide additional analysis to improve decision making, be proactive! Initiate the effort to address the need and add value to the organization.
- Consider Timing – determine the standard review cycle in your organization, but be prepared to fill a need if it arises. Consider asking for a promotion when you are most needed by the organization.
- Initiate Discussion – take the lead in starting the discussion with your manager.

Self-Assessment

- Evaluate your skills and experience – consider your current skills and how they bring value to the organization.
- Be specific about what you want – determine what skills and experiences you want to develop as you progress through your career.
- Consider your visibility and reputation - determine if your boss is willing to support your interest in moving. It is also useful to know what senior management in the organization who have decision making authority think of the work you're doing.

Assess the Hiring Landscape

- Consider your work group – focus on the needs of your department and where there may be gaps in resources.
- Identify and align with the organization's strategic initiatives – identify projects that are of interest to the senior management and support the broader needs of the organization, making them a likely area for increased hiring and promotion.
- Research the larger marketplace – determine if competitive firms are posting similar jobs and identify any external trends such as increased regulation.

Gap Analysis

- Identify necessary skills and experiences – review job descriptions and connect to people in the role of interest to learn what is needed to succeed.

Closing the Gap

- Take on a project – it will be especially useful to take on projects within the organization that will be visible to your manager and the senior leaders. Consider leading a volunteer effort for the company or becoming part of a task force for a new initiative within the firm. You could also consider researching an area of interest and writing a white paper or creating a training session on a topic that would be of value.

Develop Champions for Your Promotion

- Find a mentor – develop a relationship with someone more senior to you who can provide guidance.
- Build an advisory board – an external advisory board can help provide a good sounding board for you as you advance in your career.

Succession Planning

- Develop a plan for how your current duties will be accomplished during and after your transition.

Resources:

Online:

- Alumni = Career Services > Advancing in Your Company > Positioning for Promotion
- E/W = Careers > Secure a Promotion > Prepare to Advance

Books (Fisher Career Resource Center):

- *Corporate Confidential* – Cynthia Shapiro
- *The Truth about Managing Your Career and Nothing but the Truth* – Dr. Karen L. Otayo
- *What Got You Here Won't Get You There* – Marshall Goldsmith

CareerCast (<https://www.chicagobooth.edu/careercast>):

- *Navigating Your Career Inside Your Company* – Scott Eblin
- *Creating Your Career Advancement Blueprint* – Karim Ismail
- *The Road to the C-Suite* – Debra Benton

Other:

- Questions? Contact Career Services by email at boothworks@ChicagoBooth.edu or by calling 312-464-8677.